so before the arrival of the prime minister's entourage. By the time she arrived at the hotel it was getting dark, but one could still see about fifty or sixty Sikh demonstrators standing at a distance of about 200m across the road, shouting anti-Indira slogans. The overall tone of the sloganeering was somewhat muted. Within twenty minutes of her arrival they had dispersed.

On 3 August, Indira Gandhi had two engagements at Los Angeles. In the morning, Mayor Tom Bradley presented her with a key to the city. During that time I quickly went to meet my sister Preet and her husband Harnek Grewal at their home in Diamond Bar, a suburb of Los Angeles. I returned in time for Indira Gandhi's address to prominent members of the local Indian community that evening. She called upon them to help improve India's image in the US. 'Spare a thought for India,' she said. She left for Honolulu the same evening for a fourteen-hour stopover. The delegation checked into Hotel Kahala Hilton late at night.

On the morning of 4 August, while Indira Gandhi was formally presenting a baby elephant to the Honolulu zoo, I did a quick round of the city accompanied by a friend from the delegation. We bumped into a Sikh driver of a Honolulu-based fishing magnate. I still remember his name. Operationally he was of no use to us, even though he was an interesting character. I parted company with the prime minister's entourage in the evening and left for New Delhi, with a night halt at Tokyo. I left Tokyo on 5 August by Air India 307 and reached New Delhi in the evening.

One-upmanship

The next morning, on 6 August, I met Suntook in his office and handed over a short note about my visit. He remarked, 'I didn't know that you can also indulge in one-upmanship'. I knew what he was referring to. I told him that it was Trivedi who had first taunted me and blamed the Department for creating an unwarranted scare. Further, as it was actionable intelligence, I felt that the IB's VVIP security team should be made aware of continuing danger to Indira Gandhi's life as soon as possible, as the PM's state visit was not yet over. Suntook didn't say anything more.